Lesson 20

GIVING

Aim: To study the importance of giving in the Kingdom of God.

Introduction:" You can give without loving, but you cannot love without giving. "

If there is going to be real love between us and God, and man with man we cannot substantiate this without giving. Giving is a vital experience of love, thus making it an important principle in the Kingdom of God.

I. WHY SHOULD CHRISTIANS BE GIVERS?

A. To imitate the example of God.

John 3:16

"For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only Son, that whoever believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life.

2 Cor. 8:9

“For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though He was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, so that you through his poverty might become rich.

B. **To obey His command**

Luke 6:38

“Give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed down, shaken together and running over, will be poured into your lap. For with the measure you use, it will be measured to you."

C. **To be a good steward**

Matthew 25:14-30

D. **To receive God's blessing**

Luke 6:38 NIV

[38] Give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed down, shaken together and running over, will be poured into your lap. For with the measure you use, it will be measured to you.”

Prov. 3:9-10

“Honour the Lord with your wealth,m with the first-fruits of all your crops; then your barns will be filled to overflowing, and your vats will brim over with new wine.”

II. WHAT SHOULD WE GIVE?

A. The Tithe

Malachi 3:6-12 NIV

[6] “I the Lord do not change. So you, the descendants of Jacob, are not destroyed. [7] Ever since the time of your ancestors you have turned away from my decrees and have not kept them. Return to me, and I will return to you,” says the Lord Almighty. “But you ask, 'How are we to return?' [8] “Will a mere mortal rob God? Yet you rob me. “But you ask, 'How are we robbing you?' “In tithes and offerings. [9] You are under a curse---your whole nation--- because you are robbing me. [10] Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, that there may be food in my house. Test me in this,” says the Lord Almighty, “and see if I will not throw open the floodgates of heaven and pour out so much blessing that there will not be room enough to store it. [11] I will prevent pests from devouring your crops, and the vines in your fields will not drop their fruit before it is ripe,

” says the Lord Almighty. [12] “Then all the nations will call you blessed, for yours will be a delightful land,” says the Lord Almighty.

Leviticus 27:30-32 NIV

[30] “ 'A tithe of everything from the land, whether grain from the soil or fruit from the trees, belongs to the Lord; it is holy to the Lord. [31] Whoever would redeem any of their tithe must add a fifth of the value to it. [32] Every tithe of the herd and flock---every tenth animal that passes under the shepherd's rod---will be holy to the Lord.

Deuteronomy 14:22-23 NIV

[22] Be sure to set aside a tenth of all that your fields produce each year. [23] Eat the tithe of your grain, new wine and olive oil, and the firstborn of your herds and flocks in the presence of the Lord your God at the place he will choose as a dwelling for his Name, so that you may learn to revere the Lord your God always.

B. Offerings

1. Love offerings

2. Missions offering

3. Other offerings

C. Ourselves

2 Corinthians 8:5

“And they did not do as we expected, but they gave themselves first to the Lord and then to us in keeping with God's will.”

III. HOW SHOULD WE GIVE?

A. Generously.

2 Cor. 9:6

“Remember this: Whoever sows sparingly will also reap sparingly, and whoever sows generously will also reap generously. “

Prov. 11:25

“A generous man will prosper; he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed.”

B. Joyously

2 Cor.9:7

Each man should give what he has decided in his heart to give, not reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver.

I Chron. 29:9

“The people rejoiced at the willing response of their leaders, for they had given freely and wholeheartedly to the Lord. David the king also rejoiced greatly.”

C. Faith.

2 Cor. 8:2-3,

“Out of the most severe trial, their overflowing joy and their extreme poverty welled up in rich generosity. For I testify that they gave as much as they were able, and even

beyond their ability. Entirely on their own”

Rom. 14:23

“But the man who has doubts is condemned if he eats, because his eating is not from faith; and everything that does not come from faith is sin.”

D. Humbly

Matt. 6:1-4

"Be careful not to do your 'acts of righteousness' before men, to be seen by them. If you do, you will have no reward from your Father in heaven. "So when you give to the needy, do not announce it with trumpets, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and on the streets, to be honoured by men. I tell you the truth, they have received their reward in full. But when you give to the needy, do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing, so that your giving may be in secret. Then your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you.

Conclusion/ Application

Start applying the biblical principle of giving no matter what your financial condition is.

Trust His promise. We cannot out-give God.